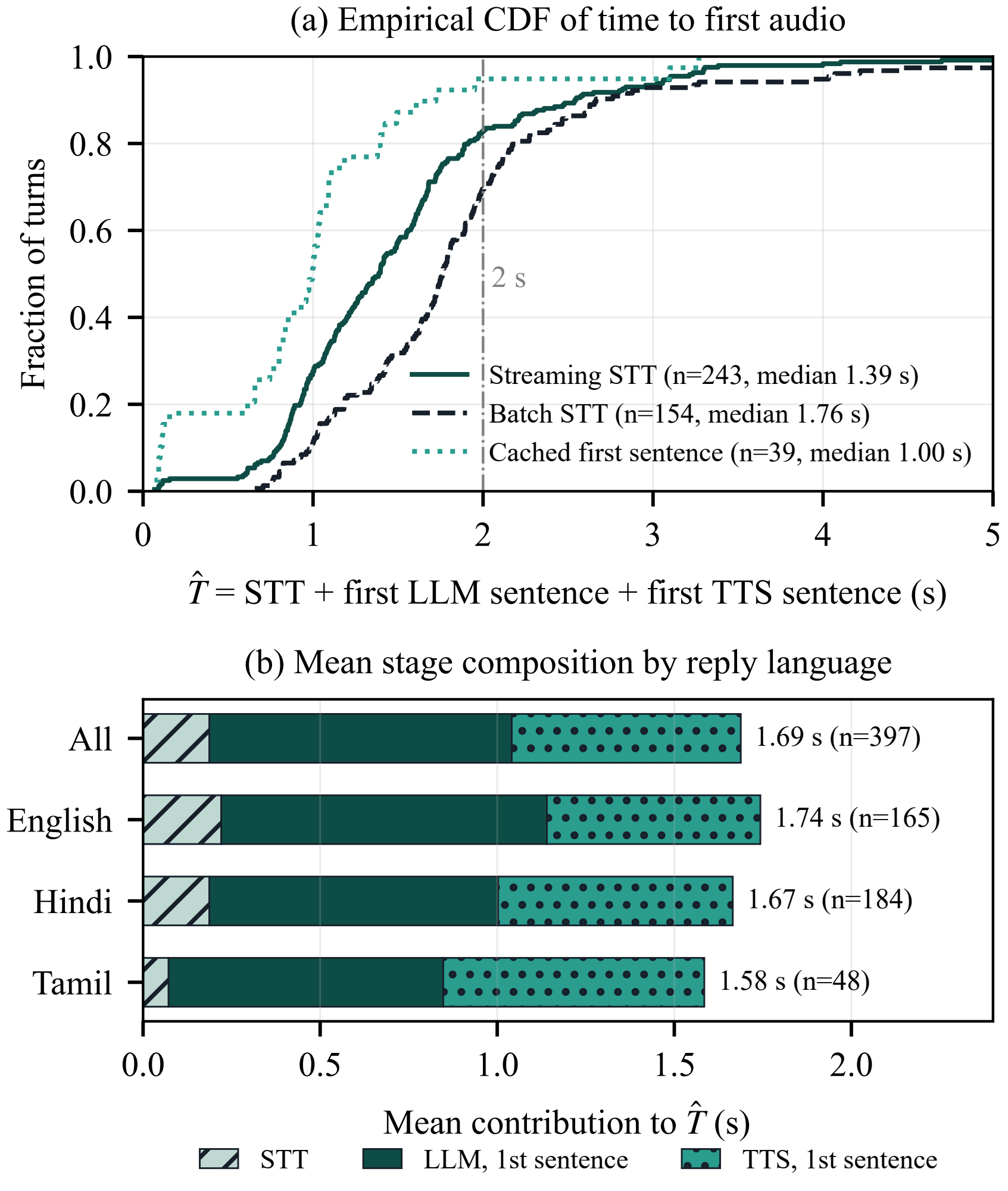

(a) Empirical CDF of time to first audio
Fraction of turns
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
0
1
2
3
4
5
2 s
Streaming STT (n=243, median 1.39 s)
Batch STT (n=154, median 1.76 s)
Cached first sentence (n=39, median 1.00 s)
$\hat{T}$ = STT + first LLM sentence + first TTS sentence (s)
(b) Mean stage composition by reply language
All
English
Hindi
Tamil
1.69 s (n=397)
1.74 s (n=165)
1.67 s (n=184)
1.58 s (n=48)
0.0
0.5
1.0
1.5
2.0
Mean contribution to $\hat{T}$ (s)
STT
LLM, 1st sentence
TTS, 1st sentence